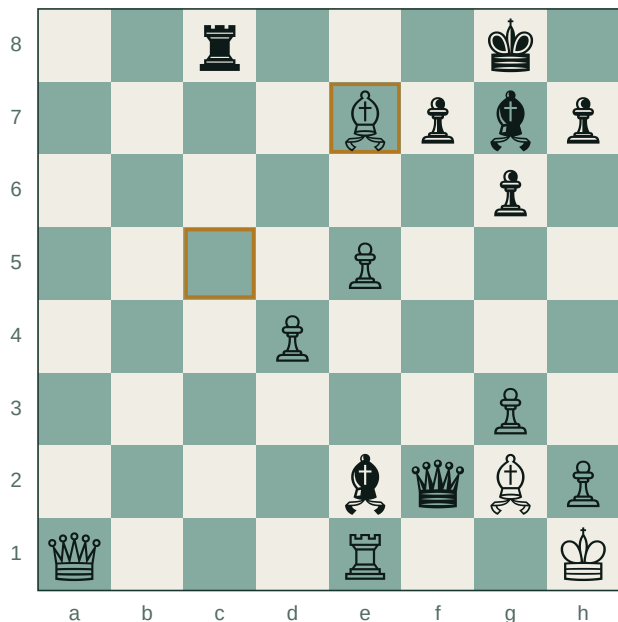


Quiet tactical moves: Black, move 32

Quiet tactical moves

Black to move



Previous move: 32.Bxe7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

32...Bf3 33. Rg1 Rc2 34. Qf1 Qxf1 35. Rxf1 Bxg2+

32...Bf3 The bishop moves from e2 to f3. Recorded reply: **33.Rg1**.

33...Rc2 The rook moves from c8 to c2. Recorded reply: **34.Qf1**.

34...Qxf1 The queen captures the queen on f1. From f1 it attacks rook on g1 and bishop on g2. Recorded reply: **35.Rxf1**.

35...Bxg2+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. From g2 it attacks king on h1 and rook on f1.

At the end, nominal material is White 12 / Black 14 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +3:** the balance goes from -1 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Because the move is not forcing by check, the opponent has time for counterplay. Test every serious check and direct threat.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A quiet move can win by threatening something the defender cannot meet, even though it gives no check and makes no capture. It often supplies the missing support in a near-working combination.

HOW TO LOOK

Use failed forcing lines to identify an escape square or defender. Search for a move that removes that resource while keeping the threat.

The defending king is on h1. Geometrically undefended: bishop on e7. Check for tactical protection.